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APPS



Tinder explores a redesign, dating ‘modes,’ and college-specific features to boost engagement

Tinder is still struggling to generate revenue from its users, as it reported a 7% dip in paying users while its parent company, Match Group, saw a 5% dip in Q2 2025 across all dating apps, including Tinder, Hinge, Match.com, and others.

To boost engagement and push more people to pay for its product, the company has undertaken multiple new initiatives. During Match's second-quarter earnings call, Match Group CEO Spencer Rascoff said that Tinder will debut a new feature called "modes," which will allow users to switch between different dating goals to explore new connections in real time. This is similar to a previous option where Tinder allowed users to put their relationship goals directly on their profiles.

IMAGE CREDITS: TECHCRUNCH

Tinder will also explore a broader redesign and other new features, including those aimed at college students, to drive more usage among Gen Z.

Another new feature allows users to like specific parts of a profile, nudging people to start conversations based on those likes, similar to Match's dating app Hinge.

The changes arrive amid a mixed quarter for the dating app giant, which reported flat year-over-year revenue of \$864 million and earnings that declined from \$133.3 million year-over-year to \$122.5 million in Q2. However, the company provided a better-

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than-expected Q3 outlook with revenue reaching \$910-920 million, which boosted its stock post-earnings.

Match also announced it would invest \$50 million in product development, as the dating app maker aims to connect with younger Gen Z users and use AI to improve its products.

“We’ll take the first steps towards a new UI refresh in Q3 with a cleaner, faster, and more modern look across the entire app,” Rascoff said. “We’re on track to test version one of a redesigned ‘see who likes you’ tab this fall with the goal of helping users connect with people they’re more likely to be interested in, as well as to drive more revenue,” he added.

In the case of the latter, Tinder continues to experiment with [AI-powered matching](#), which it debuted in New Zealand earlier this year. The feature delivers curated matches based on information from your Tinder profile, answers to questions, and, optionally, insights from the user’s camera roll photos.

Now, the company intends to roll out this feature to more geographies.

“The interactive matching experience we’ve been testing in New Zealand is specifically designed to appeal to this type of audience [users under 30]: Somebody who doesn’t just want to be judged based on their physical appearance. [The feature is for] somebody who instead is willing to put in a little bit of time, answer some questions, and then get a custom result back,” Rascoff said.

Plus, Rascoff noted that Tinder is thinking about launching more college-specific features, including allowing users to just search within their

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college or other selected colleges, to appeal to younger users.

The company also offered an update on Tinder's [Double Date option](#), launched in June, that lets users pair up with a friend to match with another couple. The dating company said it saw positive results with 92% of users utilizing the feature being under 30.

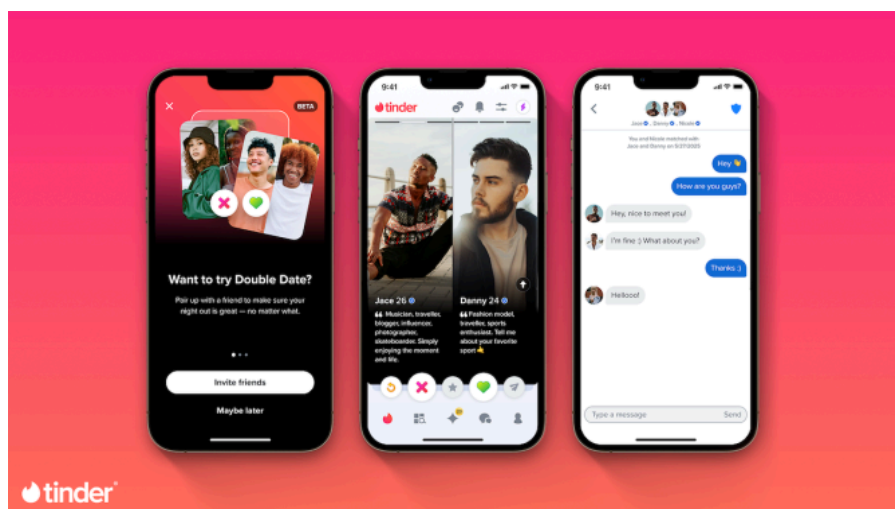


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This was Rascoff's first full quarter at the helm of Match Group, as the Zillow Group co-founder and Match board member was [appointed](#) CEO in February.

Earlier this year, the company announced that Faye Iosotaluno would step down from the app's CEO position in July, with Rascoff taking on the role. The company also laid off 13% of its staff (around 325 people) in May, and [closed open roles](#).

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Match to lay off 13% of staff

Ram Iyer — 6:07 AM PDT · May 8, 2025

Dating app giant Match Group is laying off 13% of its staff as part of a reorganization that aims to reduce costs, shore up margins, and streamline its organizational structure.

The layoff would affect about 325 employees, based on the 2,500 employees Match had as of December 2024, per its annual filing. Open roles are also being closed.

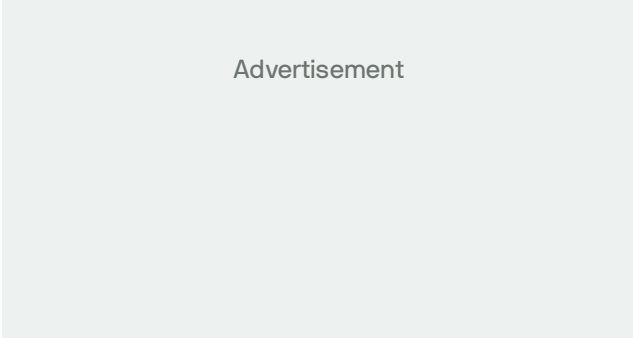
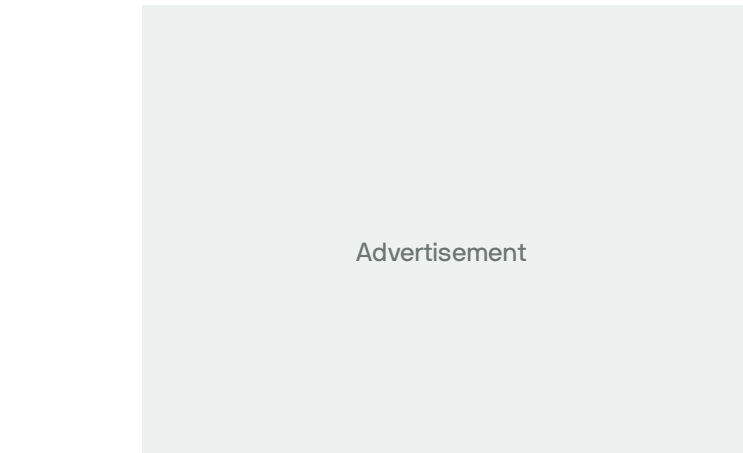
The reorganization is meant to reduce management layers, with about one in five managers affected, and centralize key functions — including technology and data services, customer care and content moderation, media buying, and international go-to-market functions, the company said.

Spencer Rascoff, who came on board as CEO in February, said in a statement that the move was aimed at helping Match operate as one company, not brands that are managed independently. Match is the parent company of several popular dating apps, including Tinder, Hinge, Match.com, Meetic, OkCupid, Plenty of Fish, and OurTime.

The cost cuts and reorganization would help Match save over \$100 million (annualized), and about \$45 million in 2025, Rascoff said in a statement.

Match also said first-quarter revenue declined 3% to \$831.2 million from a year earlier due to a 5% drop in the number of users who paid for a service or subscription. Net profit declined 4.6% year-on-year to \$117.6 million.

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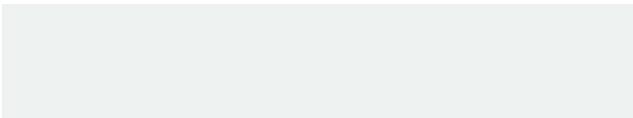
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Happy Valentine’s Day, dating app downloads are slowing down

Sarah Perez — 10:48 AM PST · February 14, 2024

It may be Valentine's Day here in the U.S., but the dating app market isn't looking as promising as it used to. According to a new [analysis](#) by app intelligence provider data.ai, global downloads of dating apps saw only tepid growth year-over-year as of this January — a slight increase of just 1.9% to reach 128 million installs, compared with the 29% increase seen during the same time in the prior year. In the U.S., growth has also slowed, with a 2.38% year-over-year increase as of January 2024, reaching roughly 12.7 million installs, down from the nearly 16% growth seen in January 2023.

While data.ai likes to paint any growth as a positive sign for the industry, there are other signals that the market is losing steam.

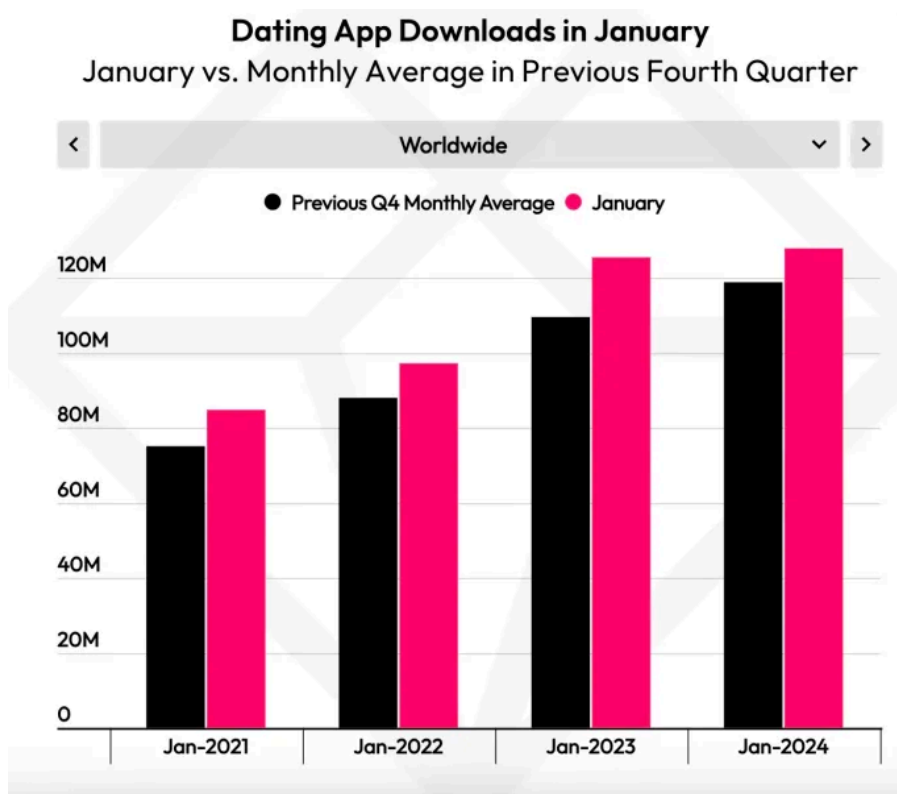


IMAGE CREDITS: DATA.AI

Dating app giant Match Group, which operates Match, Tinder, Hinge, OkCupid, and others, reported its total number of paying customers declined by 5% year-over-year as of its fourth-quarter earnings report in January. In the prior quarter, the company had reported a 6% decline in customers paying for its flagship app, Tinder, [which sent the stock tumbling](#).

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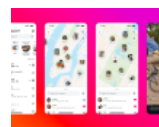
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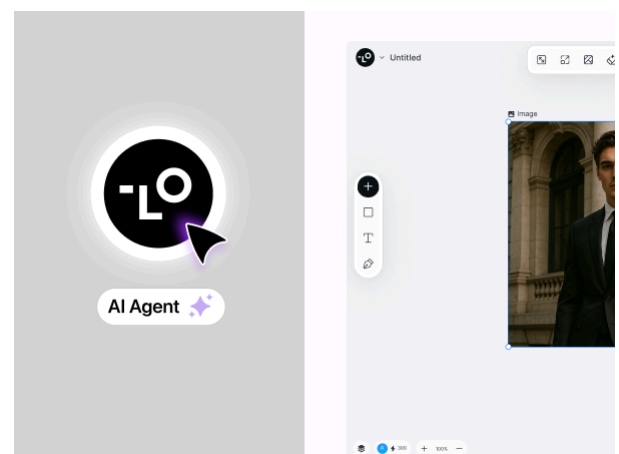
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Tinder’s paying customer growth also slowed again last quarter, dropping 8% year-over-year to reach 10 million payers, the company said in its shareholder letter.

Though Match Group still beat estimates on fourth-quarter earnings and revenue — the latter up 10% year-over-year to \$866.23 million — it’s become increasingly clear that’s because the company has learned how to squeeze more dollars out of a shrinking paying user base. Case in point: Tinder launched a [ridiculously priced \\$500 per month subscription](#) called Tinder Select last fall, which promised to match subscribers with the “most sought after” profiles — an idea it picked up from its [2022 acquisition](#) of high-end dating app The League.

In the U.S. market, one of the largest for dating apps, [only three in 10 adults reported](#) ever using a dating site or app, Pew Research reported last year. That figure remains the same as in [2019](#), the firm pointed out.

Meanwhile, although [one in 10 U.S. adults](#) said they met their partner on a dating app or website, dating apps’ broader success on that front is questionable.

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A [recent analysis of U.S. Census Bureau data](#) found that a record number of 40-year-olds ([one-quarter](#)) have never been married, up from just 6% in 1980. Arguably, this reflects other factors — including the acceptance of unmarried partners living together and the inclusion of same-sex couples into marriage data. Still, given [that 44% of U.S. dating app users](#) said they turned to dating apps to find a long-term partner, as opposed to wanting more casual relationships, it's not clear that today's apps have been able to deliver.

In addition, Tinder's hold on the U.S. dating app market appears to be waning ever so slightly, data.ai's new report shows. As of last month, it had the largest market share of any other dating app at 29.3%, but this is down from 29.8% a year ago.

United States Consumer Spend Market Share Top Dating Apps in January 2024 vs. 2023

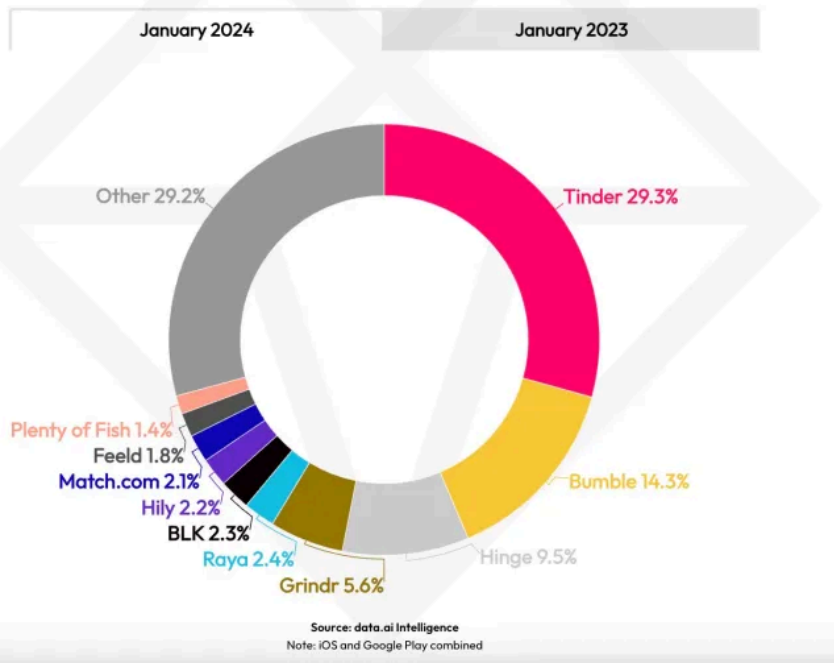


IMAGE CREDITS: DATA.AI

To date, Tinder has seen a total of 530 million downloads, the company shares [on its website](#), but Match also admitted in Q4 that both Tinder's U.S. and global daily new users had declined by the mid-single digits year-over-year, in addition to the decline in its paying customers.

Bumble's share, meanwhile, shrunk from 17.6% to 14.3 % year-over-year, [data.ai found](#), to come in at number two.

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The “Other” category of dating apps, which includes the smaller companies and startups experimenting with new models, grew from a 27.4% market share in January 2023 to 29.2% in January 2024. This seems to indicate that among dating app users, there's a growing desire for something new.

Things could still turn around, of course. Match [said](#) it will now look to AI to improve the dating app

experience, including in areas like its photo picker, matching capabilities, and post-match guidance, by augmenting features like conversation starters and nudges with AI.

This follows on news that [an increasing number of people](#) are turning to AI tools like ChatGPT to help them with their dating app chats. An AI dating tool Rizz went viral and has seen downloads rise in the months following its [Washington Post write-up](#). According to data from app intelligence provider [Appfigures](#), Rizz has seen north of 2.24 million downloads over the past year, for example.

Whether AI can send more people back to dating apps, of course, remains to be seen, given that it will also likely inspire more AI-powered romance scams and other malicious activity, security firm McAfee [recently warned](#).

All this doesn't mean the market isn't ripe for investment, however. In addition to the changes driven by AI, Match proves that dating apps can still deliver big dollars when properly monetized. Data.ai noted that dating apps generated a [record \\$505 million](#) in January 2024, even as year-over-year revenue growth slowed to 8% from 17% the year prior.

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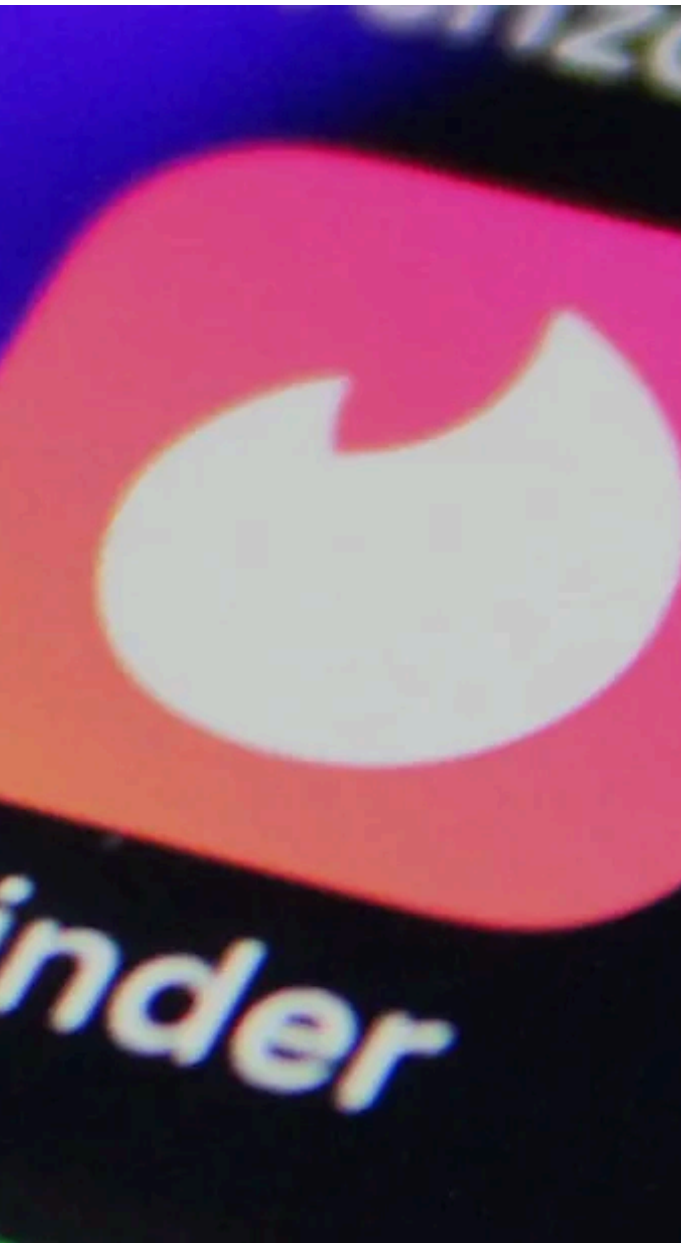


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AI



Tinder will try AI-powered matching as the dating app continues to lose users

Sarah Perez — 1:31 PM PST · February 6, 2025

Tinder hopes to reverse its ongoing decline in active users by turning to AI. In the coming quarter, the Match-owned dating app will roll out new AI-powered features for discovery and matching. The addition aims to offer fatigued singles an alternative to the “swipe” that defined the dating app in its earlier days and influenced an entire industry to adopt the gesture as the go-to standard.

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In its Q4 earnings release, the company noted that the AI-curated recommendations would deliver more “personalized and engaging matches.” Match Group CFO Gary Swidler told investors on the Q4 earnings call that the AI-driven matching feature will give users “something other than swiping” as a way to meet.

However, he clarified that AI matching would be a complement to swiping, not a replacement.

“We want to see a significant number of people engage with that feature and give it a try ... We also want to see improvement in quality matches,” Swidler said. “We want to see that product really deliver for people in terms of enhanced quality matches that will improve the perception of the product, which should help us drive user growth.”

Also mentioned on the call was another AI feature, the AI Photo Finder, which helps users pick out the best profile photos for their dating profiles. It launched last year.

AI-powered additions come at a challenging time for Tinder and the dating app industry as a whole.

Over time, young singles have grown [tired of online dating](#), which they say no longer feels spontaneous and fun and instead seems [more like work](#). Amid safety and privacy concerns, bad behavior from fellow dating app users, and a realization that these apps had presented an illusion of choice when, in reality, their potential for matches was more limited, consumers have been leaving Tinder and others behind.

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During the call, the company admitted that Tinder's global user growth was still in decline.

In October, Tinder's monthly active users (MAUs) were down 10% year over year, a number that only slightly increased to reach a 9% decline over the next two months.

The app then saw MAUs decline "about 8%" in January, which execs tried to spin as a positive signal.

Tinder's direct revenue also missed the company's internal guidance, coming in at \$476 million, below the forecast range of \$480-\$485 million.

“I’d love to see us get back to growth, but I think we have to take the baby steps first. We’ve got to roll out these product initiatives, see them drive improved user trends,” Swidler said of the new products, including the AI discovery and matching features. The company also plans to make its “Friends in Common” feature more broadly accessible.

As part of its attempt at course correction, Match Group [named](#) Zillow Group co-founder Spencer Rascoff as its new CEO.

Rascoff spoke bullishly on the potential for AI-powered online dating, saying that he thought that “this Cambrian explosion in AI is going to allow Match Group to have the same kind of business inflection that the shift from desktop to mobile created for our category and other categories around 10 years ago — when mobile exceeded desktop.”

That’s quite the bet.

He pointed to other consumer mobile apps like TikTok, Instagram, and Snapchat that benefited from AI features in terms of both engagement and retention, adding, “I see the same potential for us.”

While Match execs may be optimistic, it’s clear that the dating app market is headed for change.

Beyond Tinder’s declines, the company [missed estimates in Q4](#) with earnings of 82 cents per share, below analyst expectations of 84 cents. While it delivered on revenues, bringing in \$860 million in the quarter, above estimates, it also [represented a 0.7% year-over-year decline](#). In its Q1 2025 [guidance](#), the company said it planned for revenues of \$820 million to \$830 million, down 3 to 5% year-over-year, thanks to Tinder’s negative MAU trends.



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